

INTERNATIONAL LANGUAGES

OVERVIEW

In courses in international languages, students develop their listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills in order to communicate in the language of study (the target language) in a variety of contexts and for a variety of purposes, with a focus on real-life situations and uses. Through their exploration of a wide variety of authentic materials and meaningful activities, students develop not only language skills but also the skills necessary for lifelong language learning. They also acquire an understanding and appreciation of diverse communities around the world where the target language is spoken, and make connections to their own community.

Language structures and conventions that are appropriate for each level are listed in the Language Knowledge chart for international languages that is provided in Appendix B. Students should be given ample opportunities to demonstrate and extend their understanding of the language elements by applying them in a wide variety of contexts across the strands. Two additional charts are provided to assist teachers in planning learning activities – Topics for Developing Vocabulary, and Cultural Concepts for Developing Intercultural Understanding.

The expectations for courses in international languages are organized into four distinct but related strands:

Listening

Oral communication skills lay the foundation for the acquisition of any new language, and pave the way for learning to read and write in that language. Well-developed listening skills are essential for students' development of the proficiency in the target language that they will need to succeed in the program. To develop their listening and interaction skills, international language learners need extensive opportunities to listen to and interact with others. They also need to develop listening skills in order to understand what is said during classroom presentations, in radio and television broadcasts, and in many other contexts. At first, students listen to directions and instructions; as they progress, they are able to take point-form notes in class; and eventually, they are able to provide a summary of a presentation.

International language learners need many opportunities to listen to a range of subjects, including topics that interest them, concepts in school subjects, and contemporary issues. Students listen to words, phrases, and passages in the target language in order to identify standard pronunciation and to improve their reading comprehension. Students listen to explanations of language structures and conventions and cultural concepts. They also

listen to a wide range of oral texts representing formal and informal social registers and various genres and forms appropriate to their interests (e.g., podcasts, videos, song lyrics, radio shows, electronic sources, poetry, short stories, advertisements, video games, radio shows). They also need exposure to oral texts of increasing difficulty in the target language, such as longer radio broadcasts or documentaries on more complex topics.

It is important that teachers contextualize listening interactions and activities for students. This can be done through brainstorming to identify what students already know about the topic of a new text they are about to hear or view. Some examples of richly integrated tasks are: discussing strategies for organizing ideas for a writing assignment; presenting and defending ideas or debating current issues; and offering constructive and descriptive feedback about work produced by their peers.

Speaking

Oral language is a fundamental means of communicating with others and the cornerstone of learning in all areas. Students build a broad range of speaking skills, both for conversational purposes and for academic purposes, such as presenting ideas and information to their classmates. At first, students engage in brief conversations on everyday topics; as they progress, they engage in speaking tasks such as sharing ideas about a variety of texts in a literature circle; and eventually, they are able to present classroom seminars or participate in debates.

International language learners need rich and frequent opportunities to speak and interact in the classroom in a purposeful way – for example, through collaborative learning in pairs and small groups that allows them to engage in speaking and listening for real-life purposes. Through multiple opportunities to speak in various groupings, students begin to communicate effectively and to gain confidence as they explore ideas and concepts, identify and solve problems, organize information, and express and clarify their thoughts, feelings, and opinions. An opportunity for self-reflection about their speaking skills and strategies enables students to strengthen their ability to express themselves and interact with other speakers of the target language.

It is important that teachers not only offer instruction and feedback, but also provide excellent models of the competence that a first-language speaker would demonstrate in speaking for both academic and social purposes. Teachers at all course levels should also provide modelling of various special sound features of the international language, and include instruction on norms and conventions associated with speaking the language in different cultures.

Reading

This strand provides extensive opportunities for students to build on their experience in listening to and speaking the target language to help them determine the meaning of written texts in the target language. Students read a wide variety of adapted and authentic literary, informational, and graphic texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. They activate their background knowledge, acquire vocabulary, think aloud about what they are reading, discuss texts with peers, and participate in group reading and learning activities. An effective reader not only grasps the ideas communicated in a text but is able to apply them in new contexts. To do this, the student must be able to think clearly, creatively, and critically about the ideas and information encountered in texts. The student can then understand, analyse, and absorb them and recognize their relevance in other contexts. The international languages curriculum develops the knowledge, strategies, and skills that will enable students to become effective readers in the target language.

As learners develop their reading skills in the target language, it is important that they have many opportunities to read a wide variety of texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. By reading widely, students will develop a richer vocabulary, become more attuned to the language structures and conventions of the target language in various genres, and increase their understanding of diverse world views.

Reading is a complex process that provides a bridge between speaking and writing. Students learning to read in the target language are also acquiring knowledge of new vocabulary and language structures, as well as a new phonological awareness of the sound system of the target language. Reading also involves the application of many comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading. Teachers need to model the use of such strategies, engage students in shared and guided exploration of texts, and foster the independent application of reading strategies. Students need to identify which strategies are personally most helpful and how they can use these and other strategies to improve as readers. For example, students might prepare before reading by identifying the purpose of the reading activity and by activating their prior knowledge about the topic of the text and the vocabulary contained in that text.

During reading, students may use clues from context or from their understanding of language elements and structures to help them determine the meaning of unfamiliar words. They will also use a variety of comprehension strategies such as predicting, questioning, identifying main ideas, and monitoring comprehension to help them understand a text. After reading, students may analyse, synthesize, make connections, evaluate, and use other critical and creative thinking skills to achieve a deeper understanding of the material they have read. For example, students might evaluate an author's perspective or bias in a piece of writing and discuss how that might affect the reader's interpretation.

To become fluent readers of the target language, students need to read frequently and develop the range of skills required to read for a variety of different purposes – to follow directions, to get advice, to obtain information, to build vocabulary, to obtain access to subject knowledge, and for personal interest and enjoyment.

It is important that students read a range of authentic materials illustrating the many uses of writing, since these texts will serve as models for texts that they will create. The reading program should therefore include a wide variety of literary, informational, fictional, and graphic texts – for example, short story, myth, legend, folk tale, poem, song, novel, play, report, newspaper or magazine article, television or radio script, manual, advertisements, autobiography, chart, diagram, graphic novel, comic book, recipes, and instructions.

Writing

From their experience with oral communication and reading, students acquire the skills they need to become good writers who are able to communicate ideas and opinions with ease and clarity. Current research confirms the similarity in the writing processes of both first- and second- language writers. The elements that go into writing in any language are essentially similar: selecting a topic; organizing and developing ideas to be included; choosing the form of writing and level of language appropriate to the audience and the purpose for writing; applying the conventions of written language such as grammar, spelling, punctuation, and word choice; and applying editing, revising, and proofreading strategies to produce a polished piece of writing.

However, for students who are learning a second language, the planning stage of the writing process is critical. Students must become skilled at choosing the correct vocabulary in the target language,

while selecting and organizing their ideas. They must also keep in mind the purpose for which they are writing and the audience they are addressing. To communicate clearly and effectively, they need to learn to use standard written forms and the language conventions of the target language.

Students who are beginning to write in the target language need to read a wide variety of texts that expose them to uses of vocabulary, grammatical elements, and idioms that they will need when writing their own texts. As students read a variety of written texts, they not only increase their vocabulary but also learn to vary their sentence structure, their organizational approach, and the voice they use in their writing. Students should produce a variety of forms or types of writing, such as descriptions, letters, journal entries, advertisements, brochures, summaries, reviews, dialogues, poems, short stories, questionnaires, newspaper articles, essays, and reports. Students should be given opportunities to produce interactive writing, different types of creative writing, as well as writing that addresses topics of interest to them and reflects their capacity for independent critical thought. Writing activities that are seen by students as meaningful and that challenge them to think critically and creatively will help them achieve a fuller and more lasting command of the essential skills of writing. Students' writing activities, in turn, support and reinforce both their oral language skills and their reading skills.

In addition, all students, whether they are writing in their first language or any other language, need to be taught ways to avoid plagiarism when writing for reporting and research purposes.

For more information about effective instruction in the four strands, consult the ministry resource document entitled *Adolescent Literacy Guide: A Professional Learning Resource for Literacy, Grades 7–12, 2013*.

International Languages, Level 3

Open

LBADO – LDYDO

This course provides opportunities for students to communicate and interact in the language of study in a variety of practical contexts and real-life situations. Students will refine their listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills, as well as their creative and critical thinking skills, as they explore and respond to simple and some complex oral and written texts, including authentic texts. They will also increase their understanding and appreciation of diverse communities where the language is spoken, and develop skills necessary for lifelong language learning.

Prerequisite: International Languages, Level 2, University Preparation or Open

A. LISTENING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. Listening to Understand:** determine meaning in a variety of oral texts in the target language, using a range of listening strategies;
- A2. Listening to Interact:** interpret messages accurately while interacting in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- A3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in oral texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

A1.1 Using Listening Comprehension

Strategies: identify a range of listening comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after listening to understand simple and complex oral texts in the target language (e.g., use contextual cues to make inferences while listening; listen for key words indicating sequence to help them retell a story in the correct order; generate mental images while listening to help them retain information; use a summary chart to record key ideas after a discussion; formulate questions after listening to a presentation to prompt the speaker to clarify information)

Teacher prompts: “As you listen, try to identify contextual cues that will help you infer what the message is about. What can you hear in the background, for example, that tells you where the dialogue is located?” “As you listen, generate a mental image of what you hear. What kinds of images will help you remember a sequence of events or a list of items, for example?”

A1.2 Demonstrating Understanding: demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and meaning of oral texts in the target language that contain information and ideas about a variety of topics, with contextual and visual support as appropriate (e.g., list language structures used to express emotions or desires in an authentic folk

tale read aloud; summarize key ideas and list supporting details in an oral report about current issues of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit peoples; infer the product being promoted in a radio commercial; identify key phrases in a pre-recorded airport or airplane announcement; create an advertisement or a poster for a community event, using information heard in an announcement; identify the main concerns and solutions presented in a webcast or podcast about an environmental issue)

Teacher prompts: “What were the most important ideas in this report? What details supported each idea?” “What key phrases did the announcement contain? What makes them important?”

A2. Listening to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

A2.1 Using Interactive Listening Strategies:

identify and use a range of interactive listening strategies to suit a variety of situations while participating in social interactions and interactions about everyday matters in the target language (e.g., use culturally appropriate body language and facial expressions to acknowledge the ideas of others; use vocal prompts to signal interest in a personal account shared by a peer; paraphrase a peer’s point of view to demonstrate and confirm their understanding during a conversation; ask the teacher or a peer to repeat or clarify

feedback during a conference; ask questions and offer comments to elicit more information from a speaker)

Teacher prompt: “While you are listening to the other speaker in an interaction, think of questions you would like to ask. At what point should you ask them?”

A2.2 Interacting: respond with understanding to what others say while participating in structured and some open-ended interactions in the target language about a variety of topics, with contextual and visual support as appropriate (e.g., with a peer, improvise an interview between a staff member and a student about applying for a school co-op placement; respond to the ideas of others during a discussion about community leadership and community service; offer an opinion in response to a peer’s description of the positive and negative aspects of social networking; agree or disagree with others in a debate about the effectiveness of advertisements promoting a destination where the target language is spoken; ask questions to elicit additional information in a round-table discussion about an environmental issue such as food security or a social issue such as mental health and well-being; respond to a peer’s point of view in a group discussion about access to housing and social services in a target-language community)

Teacher prompts: “Imagine you are being interviewed for a co-op placement at a workplace that interests you. Listen carefully to the questions to determine what kinds of information the interviewer wants. How can you make the best impression?” “What sorts of questions are you likely to be asked when applying for housing at a postsecondary institution?”

A2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after listening; (b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as listeners, and plan steps they can take to improve their listening skills (e.g., describe the strategies they use most often to clarify a speaker’s message, and set goals to improve them or develop new ones; describe a situation in which a specific listening strategy was or was not helpful, and plan to modify it or apply it to new contexts)

Teacher prompt: “What works or doesn’t work well in the listening strategies you use most often? How might you improve them?”

A3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 Intercultural Awareness: using information from oral texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., record key ideas presented in an oral report about an artist, an inventor, a musician, or a historical figure from a target-language community, using a graphic organizer; listen to a radio program about youth culture in a target-language community and make connections to their own community; after listening to an audio webcast, answer questions about a social or environmental issue related to a target-language community and make connections to an issue related to a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit community; listen to a news report to determine the relationships between various cultural groups in a target-language community)

Teacher prompts: “What did you learn about this person? What do you think the information reveals about the target-language culture?” “How is youth culture different in your community and in the target-language community? How is it the same? How does identifying those differences and similarities help you to understand another culture?” “How are environmental issues in the target-language community similar to and different from environmental issues in your community?”

A3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions: using information from oral texts in the target language, identify and demonstrate an understanding of sociolinguistic conventions used in a variety of situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (e.g., identify regional variations in pronunciation and accent; identify some idiomatic and colloquial expressions in a target-language interview or speech; listen to the language register of two speakers to determine whether their relationship is familiar or unfamiliar; listen to news reports from a variety of target-language communities to distinguish between urban and rural language register)

Teacher prompt: “What elements of speech might help you identify how well two speakers know each other? What are some ways that the relationship of speakers influences the language they use?”

B. SPEAKING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Speaking to Communicate:** communicate information and ideas orally in the target language, using a range of speaking strategies, appropriate language structures, and level-appropriate language suited to the purpose and audience;
- B2. Speaking to Interact:** participate in spoken interactions in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- B3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their spoken communications in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

B1.1 Using Oral Communication Strategies:

identify a range of speaking strategies and use them to express themselves clearly and coherently in the target language for various purposes and to a variety of audiences (*e.g., rehearse a speech in front of a small group of peers before delivering it to the class; practise delivering lines in front of a mirror before a role play; use personal anecdotes to engage their audience; use audio-visual aids to supplement and enhance a presentation; use familiar and newly acquired phrases and sentences in new speaking contexts*)

Teacher prompts: “What effect does rehearsing your message have on your speaking skill and your satisfaction with your performance?” “What can you do to ensure that audio-visual material will support your presentation rather than distract your audience?”

B1.2 Producing Oral Communications:

produce rehearsed, some detailed, and spontaneous messages in the target language to communicate information and ideas about a variety of topics, with contextual, auditory, and visual support as appropriate (*e.g., describe past and present activities, interests, and plans for the future; present a critique of a graphic novel or video game; deliver a presentation on a cultural event, using visual aids and notes; retell a children’s story; create and perform a new verse for a traditional target-language song;*

compose and deliver a public service announcement about a product recall; present a summary of a current or proposed environmental project, such as mining, forestry, wind turbine farms, or clean water access, in a country where the target language is spoken; describe the skills necessary to complete an internship, work placement, or study-abroad term successfully)

Teacher prompts: “What activities interest you? How do they affect your plans for the future? Share an example.” “What information is essential to include in a product recall? How can you make sure that your listeners get the details they need from your announcement?”

B1.3 Speaking with Fluency: speak with a smooth pace, appropriate intonation, and standard pronunciation in rehearsed and spontaneous communications in the target language about a variety of topics (*e.g., recite tongue twisters accurately at different rates and with different emphases; role-play with expression a scene from a book or play that the class is reading; recite a memorized poem expressively; use pauses and intonation for emphasis when delivering a presentation; express personal preferences with ease in a conversation with a peer*)

Teacher prompts: “What is the effect of reciting a tongue twister at different speeds? What happens with different emphases? How do these changes affect your pronunciation and pace?” “How might you use tone of voice to affect your listener as you recite a poem?”

B1.4 Applying Language Knowledge: use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their meaning clearly in the target language

B2. Speaking to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 Using Conversation Strategies: identify and use a range of conversation strategies to suit a variety of formal and informal situations while participating in simple and some detailed spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., use verbal and non-verbal communication to encourage others to join a conversation; agree or disagree politely using appropriate expressions; make respectful suggestions for next steps in group work; repeat or rephrase their message when a peer has not understood it*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some polite ways to express disagreement?” “How can you make sure that each member of your group feels heard?”

B2.2 Interacting: engage in structured and spontaneous spoken interactions in the target language about a variety of topics, with teacher modelling and support as appropriate (*e.g., share career ideas in a small group; survey classmates and community members about an environmental issue such as whether to build an oil pipeline; exchange opinions with a peer about a school issue such as homework expectations; with a partner, role-play bargaining in a marketplace; in a small group, discuss some pros and cons of purchasing certain furniture, appliances, and other goods for a college or university residence*)

Teacher prompts: “When exchanging opinions with a peer, how might you demonstrate respect for your partner’s opinion while asserting your own view? Give an example.” “What questions would you ask when bargaining? What expressions might you use to get a better price from the vendor?”

B2.3 Metacognition:

- describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after speaking to communicate effectively;
- identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as speakers, and plan steps they can take to improve their speaking skills (*e.g., describe the strategies they find most helpful when contributing to a group discussion; plan to reflect on feedback from peers and the teacher on revising the form of their spoken messages; keep track of sounds and vocabulary that have given them*

difficulty and seek opportunities to practise them; plan to use a checklist to help them monitor their participation in a debate)

Teacher prompt: “What aspects of speaking do you find most difficult? How can you improve them?”

B3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 Intercultural Awareness: communicate information orally in the target language about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., deliver a presentation on the significance of a specific cultural attraction in a country or region where the target language is spoken; introduce a music video from a country where the target language is spoken, noting typical linguistic and national characteristics; dramatize a traditional target-language story; apply their knowledge of customs, attitudes, values, and beliefs in a region where the target language is spoken to describe how to deal with issues that might arise during travel*)

Teacher prompts: “Why did you select this particular attraction? How does it reflect the culture of the region?” “Why is it important to be aware of the cultural characteristics of a country or region where you are travelling? Give an example.”

B3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions: identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., use appropriate expressions to make a request or ask for information in a role play of an informal spoken interaction such as a telephone call; use appropriate body language and gestures when addressing a culturally diverse audience; use idiomatic interjections to indicate hesitation during group work; incorporate phrases and expressions related to customer-service etiquette into a skit set in a restaurant or store*)

Teacher prompts: “What spoken social convention might you use in an informal telephone call?” “As you prepare your skit, think of typical ways that a customer asks for service in a restaurant or a store. What expression would politely get the attention of a salesperson, for example? As the salesperson, what questions would you ask the customer?”

C. READING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Reading Comprehension:** determine meaning in a variety of texts in the target language, using a range of reading comprehension strategies;
- C2. Purpose, Form, and Style:** identify the purpose(s), characteristics, and aspects of style of a variety of adapted and authentic text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms;
- C3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Reading Comprehension

By the end of this course, students will:

C1.1 Using Reading Comprehension Strategies:

identify a range of reading comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after reading to understand simple texts and some complex adapted and authentic texts in the target language, in various reading contexts (*e.g., identify familiar words and cognates to support their understanding of the text; use their knowledge of typical text features to predict the text form; draw on personal experience to help them understand a character's motivation; use various visual cues to confirm their interpretation of a text; ask questions to guide their exploration of a text; refer to a concept map to identify important information and ideas in a text*)

Teacher prompt: “What questions might help you determine the motivation of the character as you read? What does your own experience tell you about the character’s motivation?”

C1.2 Reading for Meaning:

demonstrate an understanding of information and ideas in a variety of texts in the target language, including simple texts and some complex adapted and authentic texts, with teacher support as appropriate (*e.g., retell in correct sequence the events described in a novel extract; role-play a scene from a graphic novel; summarize key ideas in a legend or fable, using drama or dance; in a T-chart, categorize facts and opinions extracted from a*

newspaper or magazine advertisement or article; mime a procedure such as getting to a landmark or assembling a piece of furniture, after reading instructions from a classmate; explain their reasons for agreeing or disagreeing with the point of view expressed in a magazine article or blog; outline key points of a journal article about demographic change and cultural evolution as a result of immigration)

Teacher prompts: “Which of the arguments in this article or blog did you find persuasive? Why? Which parts did you disagree with? As you respond, remember to support your opinion by referring to relevant parts of the text.” “What did this article note about changes in recent generations of diaspora communities in Ontario and elsewhere? What points did the article make about connections to first-language cultures?”

C1.3 Reading with Fluency:

read texts in the target language at a sufficient rate and with sufficient ease to demonstrate that they understand the overall sense of the text (*e.g., in response to feedback from a partner, adjust pronunciation, intonation, and pace while reading aloud; accurately pronounce previously encountered words while reading aloud; vary their tone and expression to suit the character while reading in role*)

Teacher prompt: “What elements of the text did you find difficult to read aloud? Did your listener find them difficult to understand as well? How can you adjust your reading pace and intonation to communicate the message more clearly?”

C1.4 Developing Vocabulary: use a range of vocabulary-acquisition strategies before, during, and after reading to determine or confirm the meaning of new, unfamiliar, or recently learned words (e.g., *use knowledge of a root or word within a compound word to infer the meaning of the whole compound; consult dictionaries, thesauri, and online reference resources to extend and enhance their vocabulary; identify synonyms and antonyms for familiar words encountered while reading, and keep a notebook to build vocabulary; create a personal lexicon of recently learned words, including jargon and slang in online messaging and terms found in resource materials and school documents; consolidate their vocabulary acquisition by using memory aids, visualization techniques, and/or thematic lists of key concepts*)

Teacher prompts: “How can you use familiar vocabulary to build new vocabulary?” “What familiar smaller word can you see inside the larger word? How does your knowledge of its meaning help you find the meaning of the new word?”

C2. Purpose, Form, and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 Purposes and Characteristics of Text

Forms: identify the purpose(s) and characteristics of a variety of text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how the characteristics help communicate the meaning (e.g., *personal opinion and anecdotes in a travelogue convey a sense of adventure; familiar characters in a fiction series allow the reader to make connections with recurring themes and storylines; diagrams and troubleshooting tips in an owner’s manual teach the consumer how to use a product; pictures and descriptions in a flyer or leaflet promote products or events; the use of a grid, icons, and colour in a calendar organizes information in a visual form*)

Teacher prompts: “How is this travelogue typical of the text form? How do its characteristics capture your imagination?” “What kinds of information does this owner’s manual highlight? Why?”

C2.2 Text Features and Elements of Style:

identify some features and stylistic elements of a variety of text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how they help convey the meaning (e.g., *alliteration and repetition emphasize particular themes in a poem; headlines, descriptive language, and photographs in a newspaper allow the reader*

to find important events or stories of personal interest quickly; tables and diagrams convey information concisely in a report; bold type and icons identify important dates in a calendar; photographs and statistics on a sports team’s website help the fan identify players)

Teacher prompts: “What features make it easy to find stories of interest in this newspaper?” “Why do you think the poet chooses to repeat this word?”

C2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after reading to understand texts;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as readers, and plan steps they can take to improve their reading skills (e.g., *keep a reading log to track their use of strategies and identify the most effective ones; confer with the teacher to develop new strategies to help them better understand challenging texts; reflect on how to select strategies for different purposes; plan to increase gradually the time they spend reading target-language texts in order to build stamina; plan to read fiction to expand their vocabulary*)

Teacher prompts: “As you look through your reading log, which strategies do you find you used most often? Why do you think that is? Were there any that you used only infrequently but that worked well?” “When you read a newspaper, what strategy could you use to find the stories that interest you? Would you use a different strategy when reading a magazine? Why or why not?”

C3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 Intercultural Awareness: using information from a variety of texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., *research an interesting cultural aspect of a country or region where the target language is spoken, and report their findings; compare the ingredients in and cultural significance of recipes from various target-language communities; identify the currency used in a target-language community and compare the cost of some everyday products in that community to their cost in Ontario; analyse the actions and choices of a character in a target-language short story in terms of the social and cultural norms of his or her community; research a career*

or trade for which knowledge of the target language is an asset, and deliver their findings in a multi-media presentation; decode clues prepared by classmates in a cultural scavenger hunt; plan and budget for a trip after reading tourism literature about a region where the target language is spoken)

Teacher prompt: “What careers or trades value knowledge of other languages? Why are they relevant?”

C3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify, in level-appropriate texts in the target language, examples of sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (*e.g., compare the level of formality in letters by writers from two different age groups; identify words and expressions used in particular countries or regions in short stories, magazine articles, poems, or blogs; identify puns in headlines from international target-language newspapers; identify examples of how the target language is used persuasively in advertisements from different countries or regions*)

Teacher prompt: “Which expressions in these letters suggest that the writers are of different ages? Which letter is more formal?”

D. WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form:** write texts in the target language for different purposes and audiences, using a variety of forms and knowledge of language structures and conventions of the written language appropriate for this course;
- D2. The Writing Process:** use the stages of the writing process – including pre-writing, producing drafts, revising, editing, and publishing – to develop and organize content, clarify ideas and expression, correct errors, and present their written work in the target language effectively;
- D3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their written work in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1 Identifying Purpose and Audience:** determine, with some support from the teacher, their purpose for writing and the audience for texts in the target language they plan to create (*e.g., to compose a follow-up e-mail thanking a guest speaker for a presentation on bullying prevention; to review fashion trends or new technology for the school newspaper; to produce a brochure promoting the value for adolescents of learning an international language; to report on a sports game or an arts performance in a letter to a community magazine; to produce a blog entry criticizing discriminatory language and its effects on school culture; to summarize for younger students the results of a survey of student attitudes towards diversity and equity; to write a proposal requesting support from the school parent's council for a school environmental initiative*)

Teacher prompts: “Considering your audience, what text form will best suit your purpose of promoting the value of language learning? Why?” “How will you adjust the language you use to summarize the survey in order to appeal to younger readers?”

- D1.2 Writing in a Variety of Forms:** write a variety of level-appropriate texts in the target language, applying their knowledge of several structural and stylistic elements of each form

(*e.g., a class word web identifying an environmental problem and possible solutions; an original fairy tale; a rap or song lyrics describing a social issue that affects adolescents, such as mental health and well-being; a captioned photo essay illustrating a current event or topic of personal interest; a storyboard for a short autobiographical film or documentary*)

Teacher prompts: “What is significant about the event your photo essay is illustrating? How can you choose images that will communicate the significant points to your audience? How can you make your captions complement and enhance the photos?” “What kinds of written directions can you add to your storyboard to explain and supplement the pictures?”

- D1.3 Applying Language Knowledge:** use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their intended meaning in written work in the target language

D2. The Writing Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1 Generating, Developing, and Organizing Content:** generate, develop, and organize ideas for writing in the target language, using a range of pre-writing strategies and resources, during modelled, shared, guided, and independent

writing activities (e.g., keep a journal of possible writing topics; participate in a small-group discussion to generate ideas for an opinion piece; use rapid writing to generate ideas and record relevant vocabulary; use the five W questions to prepare an outline for a news report; use a “plus, minus, interesting” organizer to help them classify ideas; use a graphic organizer to sort key points and supporting details into logical order for an expository essay; create a chart to categorize the types of information to include in a movie or video game review)

Teacher prompts: “What are three key points that you want to communicate in your essay? What three details might you include to support each point? How will you organize your ideas logically?” “Before you write a movie review, think about yourself as the reader. What do you need to know? What would you like to know? What will persuade you to see or not see the movie?”

D2.2 Drafting and Revising: plan and produce drafts in the target language, and revise their writing using a variety of teacher-directed and independently selected strategies (e.g., produce a draft of a report following the order of the main ideas and supporting details in their outline; use a list of teacher- and student-generated questions as a guide when correcting spelling and punctuation in their written work; identify words and expressions they use frequently, and integrate new vocabulary into their text to avoid repetition and enrich the language; reread a draft to determine whether the transitions between ideas are clear, and add, delete, or reorganize information as necessary; review peer editing of their draft to help them assess the clarity of its message; consult online and print resources while revising and editing)

Teacher prompt: “What information could you add to your draft to make the message clearer? How could you improve the transitions between ideas? How might you reorder the sequence of ideas?”

D2.3 Producing Finished Work: make improvements to enhance the clarity and readability of their written work in the target language, and use a range of elements of effective presentation to produce a polished product for publication (e.g., add appropriate visual elements to reinforce key ideas; add organizational elements such as textboxes, sidebars, and effective spacing to highlight key information in a report; check that their use of punctuation is correct and consistent with their meaning; choose design features that support the message of their text)

Teacher prompt: “Think about both the text and the space on a page. Where does the reader need to pause to absorb a key idea? How can you use space to highlight the importance of the information?”

D2.4 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after writing;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as writers, and plan steps they can take to improve their writing skills (e.g., identify the technique they find most helpful for proofreading their own written work; describe the benefits of exchanging writing ideas with a peer in a conference; describe the effectiveness of various resources they consult when correcting written work, such as the teacher, peers, and print and online references; reflect on their ability as a writer in the target language; plan to incorporate newly acquired vocabulary in future writing tasks)

Teacher prompts: “Which types of resources do you find most effective when you are correcting your work? How might some resources be unreliable?” “Describe your proofreading technique. How might you improve it?” “What new idea or approach to writing did you learn when you exchanged ideas with a peer?”

D3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 Intercultural Awareness: in their written work in the target language, communicate information about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., create a multimedia text about target-language communities in Canada, identifying their contributions to diversity; in blog entry, describe some interesting customs and traditions in a target-language community; create an FAQ section for a school website for students who are newcomers to Canada; write a film script or play about an important environmental or social issue in a country where the target language is spoken; create an advertisement to promote learning the target language, highlighting some of its features; create a poster highlighting the cuisine of a country or region where the target language is spoken)

Teacher prompts: “How have target-language communities enriched Canada?” “What information might you include in your advertisement outline to reinforce your message? Describe a persuasive way to present it.”

D3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in their written work in the target language (*e.g., use appropriate salutations and levels of formality when writing invitations for a special event to friends, the school principal, teachers, or a local government official; incorporate regional or national idiomatic expressions into a script for a commercial; conduct online research to identify regional expressions, and compare them to expressions specific to their own community in a summary chart; create a storyboard or write a skit highlighting ways in which expressions with the same meaning vary from region to region; write menus, including prices, for different types of eating establishments in a target-language community*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways can regional expressions be surprising or confusing to a non-native speaker? What example can you give? How do such expressions expand your cultural knowledge?” “What are some similarities or differences between common target-language expressions and expressions used in your own community? What did you find interesting about the differences, and what do you think they reveal about the cultures?”